

Chapter 6

Being an Effective Leader

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Managerial Functions

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graph TD; A[Managerial Functions] --> B[Planning]; A --> C[Organizing]; A --> D[Leading]; A --> E[Controlling];
```

Planning

Organizing

Leading

Controlling

Learning Outcomes

1

Differentiate between Leader and Manager

2

Describe Types of Leadership Styles & How to deal with each

3

Understand Your leadership style

4

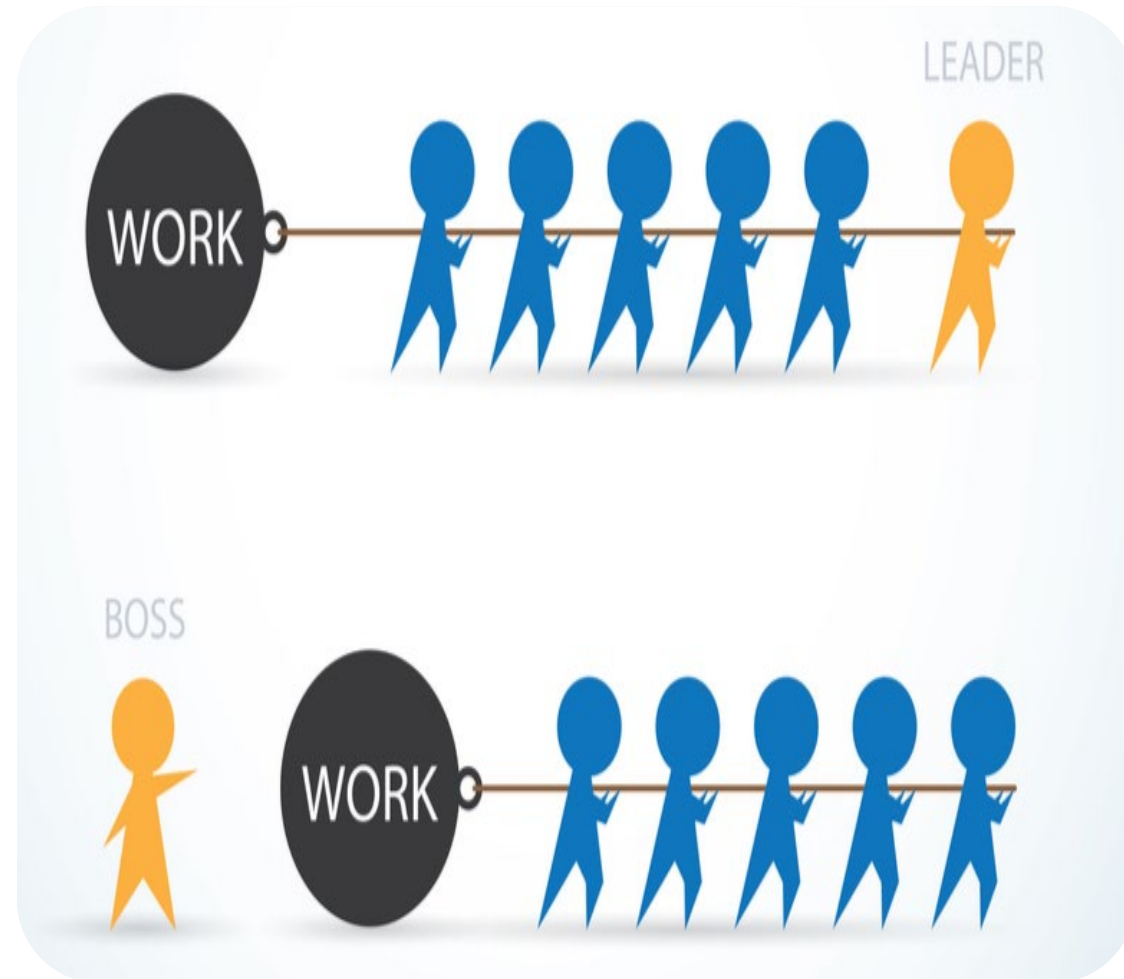
Discuss Leadership theories

Leadership

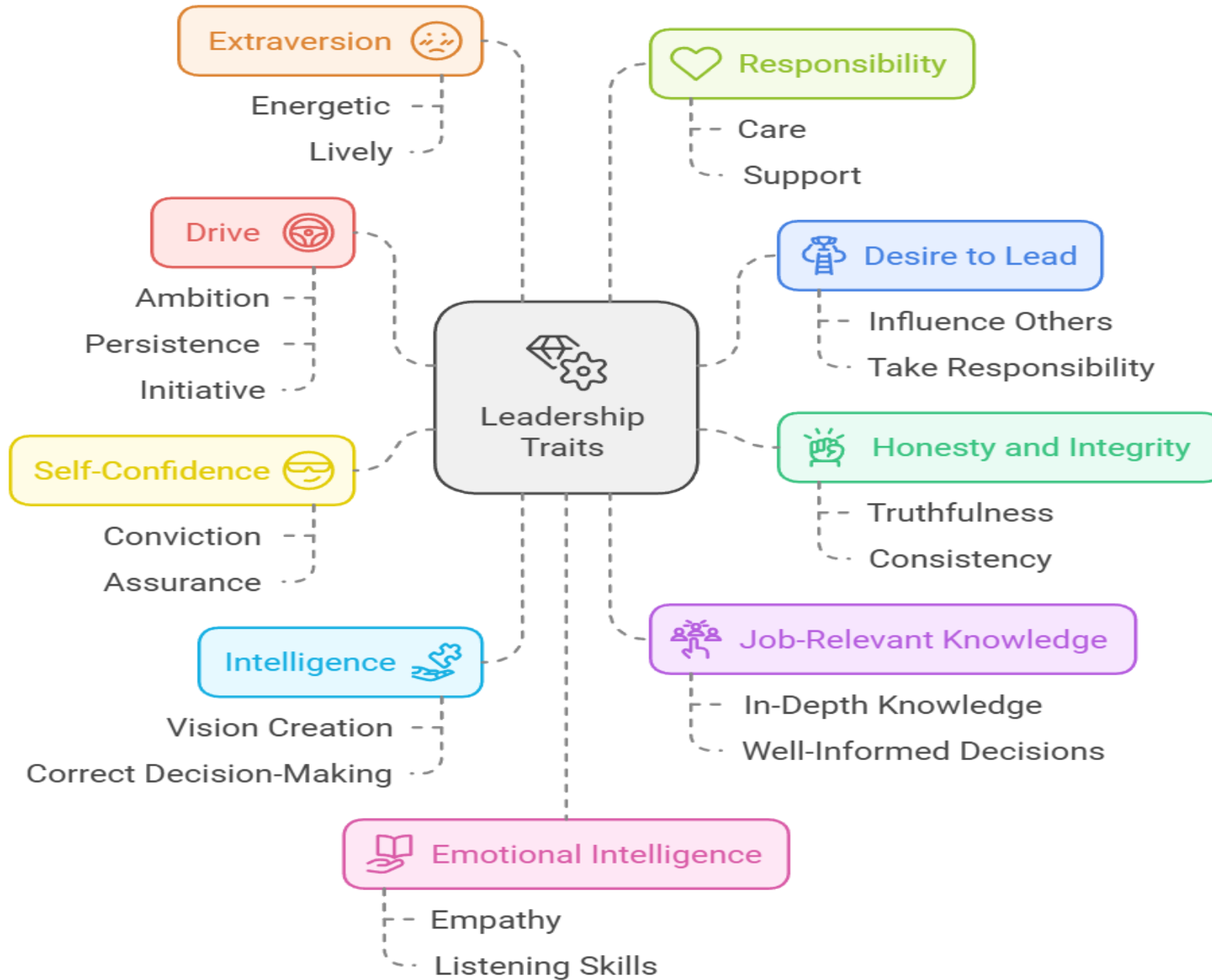
leader is someone who can **influence** others and who has managerial authority.

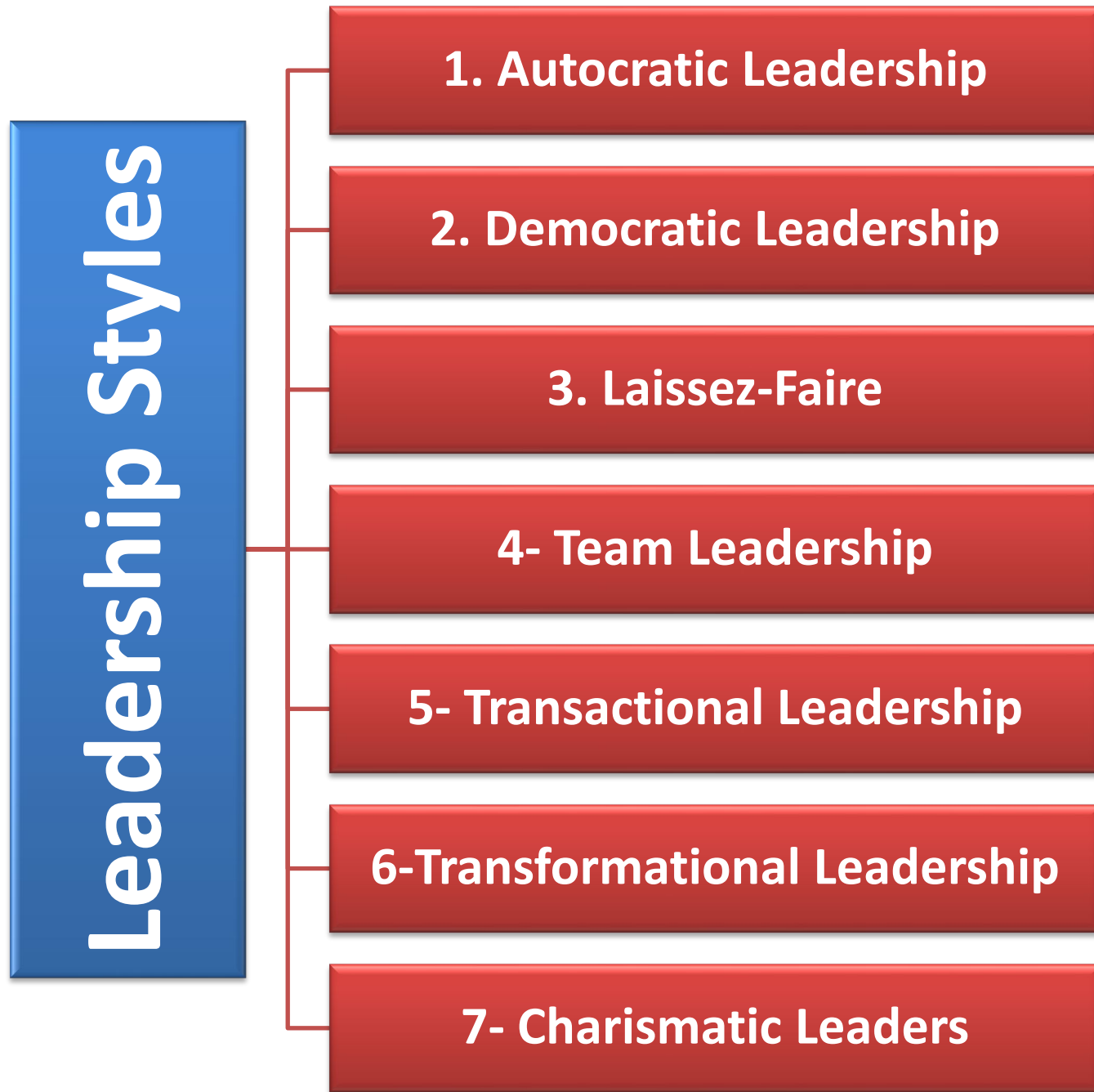
Leadership is a process of leading a group and influencing that group to achieve its goals. It's what leaders do.

- It involves guiding, directing, and motivating a group of people to achieve a shared objective.



Feature	Manager	Leader
Primary Focus	Maintaining the status quo and ensuring operational efficiency.	Driving change, innovation, and long-term vision.
Approach to Tasks	Planning, organizing, coordinating, and controlling resources to achieve goals.	Inspiring, motivating, and empowering others to contribute to a shared vision.
Decision-making	Often relies on data, analysis, and established procedures.	May consider intuition, risk-taking, and long-term impact.
Risk Tolerance	Typically risk-averse, prioritizing stability and predictability.	More willing to embrace risk and uncertainty in pursuit of innovation.
Relationship with Team	Directs and supervises team members, often with a formal hierarchy.	Builds relationships, fosters collaboration, and encourages growth.
Communication Style	Focuses on clear instructions, expectations, and performance feedback.	Communicates vision, purpose, and inspires commitment.
Source of Power	Derives power from formal authority and position within the organization.	Gains influence through trust, respect, and shared vision.
Vision	Focuses on achieving short-term objectives and meeting targets.	Sets a long-term direction and inspires others to follow.





1. Autocratic Leadership

Autocratic leaders make decisions without consulting their team members, even if their input would be useful.

- This leader makes all decisions and controls all aspects of a group or organization, without consulting or involving others.
- This style is generally considered to be directive, task-oriented, and highly centralized.

When To Use:

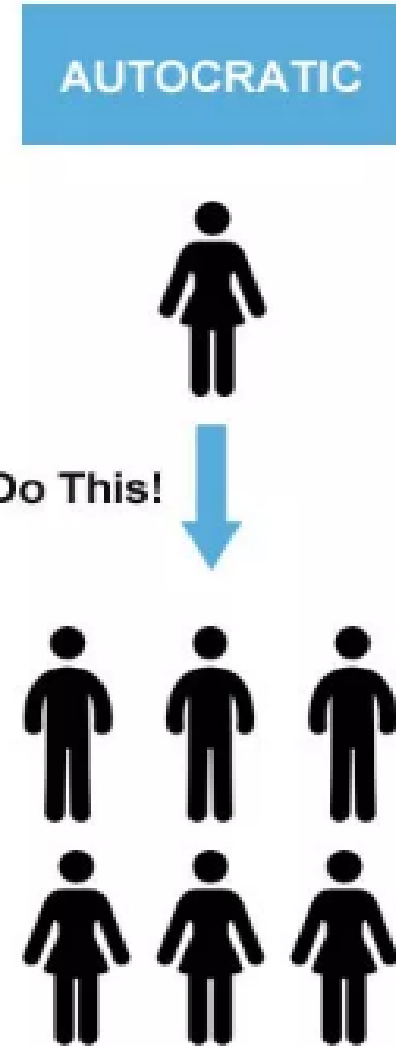
- When dealing with inexperienced or unmotivated team members.
- When there is an urgent need for quick decisions.
- In situations where the leader has more expertise.
- In times of crisis, where quick decisions need to be made to protect the organization and its members

➤ Advantages:

- Quick decision-making.
- Clear direction and expectations.
- Effective in crisis situations.

Disadvantage

- High levels of absenteeism, stress, dissatisfaction and staff turnover.
- Limited creativity and innovation which can lead to missed opportunities for growth and development.
- Lack of trust between the leader and team members



1. If You're Working UNDER an Autocratic Leader

Strategies for Employees and Team Members:

- **Understand their leadership style:**

- Recognize why they use this style (crisis mode, industry norms, past success with it)
- Acknowledge that in certain situations, directive leadership is appropriate
- When you disagree, do it privately with evidence
- Frame concerns around organizational goals, not personal preferences
- Accept that some decisions aren't yours to make

- **Build trust:**

- Delivering high-quality work, being reliable.
- Excel in your assigned role to earn trust
- Volunteer for projects where you can demonstrate independent capability
- Consistently delivering high-quality
- Demonstrate expertise in your domain
- Over-communicate progress on assigned tasks
- Gradually expand your sphere of influence through proven results
- Request autonomy in specific areas: "I'll handle this task and update you weekly"

1. If You're Working UNDER an Autocratic Leader

Strategies for Employees and Team Members:

Do This	Avoid This
Present solutions, not just problems	Complaining without alternatives
Be concise and data-driven	Long, pointless explanations
Demonstrate competence through results	Challenging their authority publicly
Ask for clarification on expectations	Assuming you know what they want
Document decisions and directives	Relying on verbal agreements only

2. If You're MANAGING an Autocratic Leader

Strategies for HR Professionals and Senior Management:

A. Assessment and Diagnosis

First, determine if the autocratic style is:

- **Situational:** Temporary response to crisis or specific challenges
- **Habitual:** Their default leadership mode across all situations
- **Effective:** Actually producing results or causing damage
- **Cultural:** Reinforced by organizational norms and industry context

Conduct a Leadership Impact Analysis:

- Employee engagement scores in their department
- Turnover rates and exit interview data, Team performance against objectives
- 360-degree feedback results, Grievance and conflict patterns

2. If You're **MANAGING** an Autocratic Leader

Strategies for HR Professionals and Senior Management:

B. Intervention Strategies

1. **Data-Driven Feedback** Present objective evidence:

- "Your team's engagement score is 45% versus the company average of 72%"
- "We've lost 3 high performers in 6 months, citing lack of autonomy"
- "Employee surveys show 68% feel their ideas aren't valued"

2. **Link to Business Outcomes** Frame the issue in terms they care about:

- "Autocratic leadership is costing us \$X in turnover costs annually"
- "Our innovation pipeline is 40% below target; teams report fear of suggesting ideas"

3. **Executive Coaching**

- Engage external coaches specializing in leadership development
- Focus on situational leadership when to be directive vs. collaborative
- Work on emotional intelligence and active listening skills
- Practice delegation and empowerment techniques

2. If You're MANAGING an Autocratic Leader

Strategies for HR Professionals and Senior Management:

C. Structured Development Plan

Timeline	Actions	Metrics
Month 1-2	360° feedback, leadership assessment, coaching begins	Baseline data collected
Month 3-4	Implement one collaborative practice (e.g., weekly team input sessions)	Meeting attendance, participation rates
Month 5-6	Delegation training, expand team decision-making authority	Number of decisions delegated
Month 7-9	Practice soliciting input before major decisions	Pulse survey on "feeling heard"
Month 10-12	Re-assess engagement, turnover, performance	Compare to baseline

2. If You're MANAGING an Autocratic Leader

Strategies for HR Professionals and Senior Management:

C. Structural and Systemic Approaches

Modify Incentives:

- Include "people development" and "team engagement" in performance metrics
- Link bonuses to 360° feedback scores
- Recognize and reward collaborative leadership behaviors

Create Forcing Functions:

- Mandate cross-functional team involvement in decisions
- Require documented consultation before major initiatives
- Implement formal feedback mechanisms (suggestion systems, town halls)
- Establish skip-level meetings where their team meets with senior leadership

D. When to Escalate or Exit Them

Consider moving them out of people management if:

- Repeated interventions show no improvement
- Their style creates legal risks (harassment, discrimination claims)
- Top talent exodus threatens business continuity
- They refuse development or coaching
- The organizational culture is shifting and they cannot adapt

2. Democratic Leadership

A leadership style where the leader involves team members in the decision-making process and encourages them to share their ideas, opinions, and perspectives but the **responsibility of making the final decision rests with him**.

This style is characterized by collaboration, open communication, and teamwork.

When To Use:

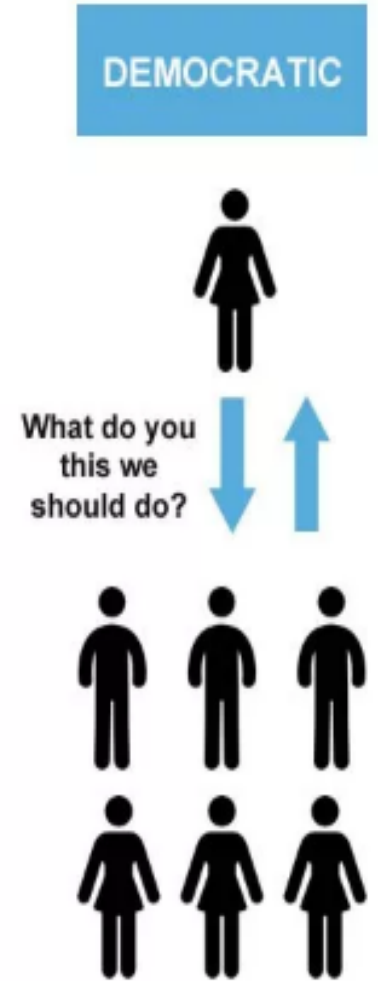
- When team members have expertise
- For projects requiring creativity and teamwork (e.g., marketing campaigns).
- In stable environments with time for deliberation

Advantage

- Boosts employee morale because employees make contributions to the decision-making process.
- Encourage creativity, and people are often highly engaged in projects and decisions. As a result, team members tend to have high job satisfaction and high productivity.

Disadvantages

- Slower decision-making.
- Can be ineffective in high-pressure situations.



How to deal with Democratic Leader

1. Understand Your Role in the Process

Critical Distinction:

- **Democratic ≠ Consensus:** The leader seeks input but makes the final call
- **Your voice matters, but you don't get a vote:** Influence, not control
- **Participation is expected, not optional:** Silence is seen as disengagement

Mental Framework: Your job is to:

- Provide informed perspectives
- Challenge ideas constructively
- Contribute expertise
- Support decisions once made (even if you disagreed)

2. Come Prepared to Every Discussion

Democratic leaders expect **practical contributions**, not just opinions.

Preparation Checklist:

- ✓ Research the issue beforehand
- ✓ Gather relevant data and examples
- ✓ Formulate a clear position with rationale
- ✓ Anticipate counterarguments
- ✓ Prepare questions to ask others
- ✓ Think about implementation implications

How to deal with Democratic Leader

3. Speak Up, Thoughtfully and Constructively

Democratic leaders **WANT** to hear from you, but how you contribute matters.

A. When You Agree: Don't just nod—add value:

- "I agree with Sarah's approach, and here's an additional benefit..."
- "That aligns with what we learned in the Q3 project..."
- "Yes, and we could strengthen it by..."

B. When You Disagree: Disagree with ideas, not people:

- ❌ "That's a terrible idea"
- ✓ "I see it differently. What if we considered..."
- ❌ "Marketing always gets this wrong"
- ✓ "My concern is X; can we explore how to address that?"

C. When You're Unsure: Ask clarifying questions:

- "Can you help me understand how this would work with our current systems?"
- "What problem are we trying to solve here?"
- "What would success look like?"

D. When You Have Nothing to Add: It's okay to say:

- "I don't have expertise in this area, but I'm learning from the discussion"
- "The perspectives shared cover what I was thinking"
- "I'll defer to the team's subject matter experts on this one"

Avoid: Talking just to be heard or repeating what others said

3. Laissez-Faire

Where the leader delegates decision-making power to the team members and provides minimal guidance or supervision.

- The essence of the style is to ensure the group itself will be in charge of outlining the objectives and creating the conditions for pursuing these goals.

When To Use:

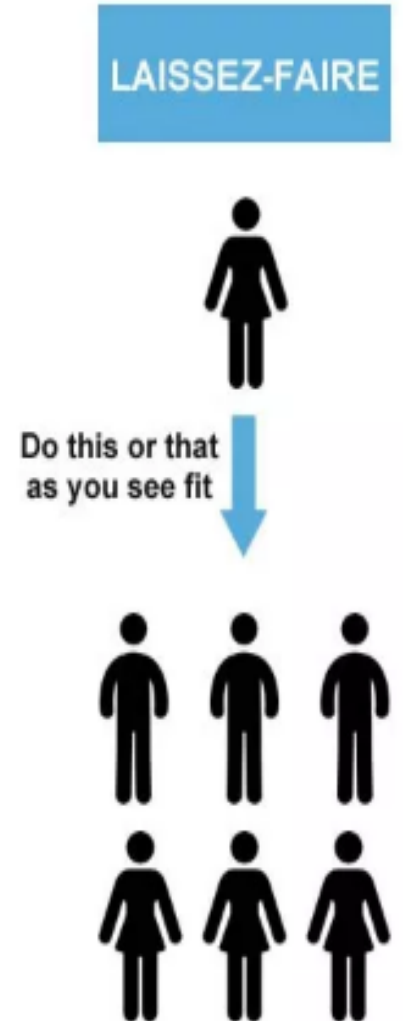
- For creative or research-driven projects.
- When leading highly skilled professionals
- When the leader is not an expert
- When flexibility is important, as it allows team members to adapt to changing circumstances and make decisions quickly.

Advantage

- High level of Job satisfaction, innovation and creativity
- subordinates are able to focus on the aspects they are most talented in, instead of having to do what they are told.

Disadvantages:

- Can lead to lack of direction or accountability.



How to deal with Laissez-Faire Leader

1. Become Self-Directed and Proactive

Without active guidance, **you must manage yourself.**

A. Set Your Own Goals and Priorities

Create Your Own Success Metrics:

- Define what "good performance" means for your role
- Set measurable targets (if the leader won't)
- Track your progress independently
- Document your accomplishments

Instead of Waiting	Take Initiative
"What should I work on?"	"Here are my top 3 priorities for Q2; does this align with your vision?"
"I'm not sure what's most important"	"Based on our team objectives, I'm focusing on X because..."
"Can you tell me what to do?"	"I see three options; I recommend A for these reasons"

2. Proactively Communicate Upward

laissez-faire leader won't ask for updates , then you must provide them Through: Regular Status Updates (Even Unsolicited)

How to deal with Laissez-Faire Leader

3. Define Boundaries and Expectations

Freedom without boundaries can lead to burnout or misalignment.

A. Clarify Role Boundaries

Ask Explicitly:

- "What decisions can I make independently versus what needs your approval?"

B. Document Agreements

After Conversations, Summarize: "Thanks for the discussion. Here's what I understand:

- I have authority to [X]
- I should check with you before [Y]
- Success looks like [Z]

4. Become a Subject Matter Expert

Laissez-faire reward deep expertise.

4. Team Leadership

is an individual who is responsible for managing and leading a team of employees towards achieving a specific goal or objective.

- The role of a team leader is critical in ensuring that the team members are motivated, engaged, and working towards achieving the goals of the organization.
- Team leadership is about **working with the hearts and minds of all** those involved.



When To Use:

- **New or inexperienced teams:** a team leader can help guide team members and ensure that they are working together effectively.
- **Complex or challenging tasks:** a team leader can help ensure that team members have the resources and support they need to succeed.

Advantage

- **Improved team performance:** ensuring that team members are working together effectively and efficiently towards achieving the organization's goals.
- **Better communication:** A team leader acts as a communication bridge between the team members and upper management. By providing regular updates, feedback, and guidance, a team leader can help ensure that everyone is on the same page and working towards the same objectives.

Disadvantages:

- Time-intensive.
- May prioritize relationships over results.

How to deal with Team Leader

1. Communication is Key:

- Be Proactive:** Don't wait for instructions. Share your ideas, ask questions, and clarify expectations.
- Active Listening:** Pay attention when your team leader speaks, ask clarifying questions, and show that you value their input.
- Constructive Feedback:** Offer your suggestions and feedback respectfully, focusing on solutions and improvements.

2. Demonstrate Your Value:

- Reliability:** Meet deadlines, fulfill your commitments, and be someone your team leader can count on.
- Initiative:** Take ownership of your tasks, seek out new challenges, and show a willingness to go the extra mile.
- Team Player:** Collaborate effectively with your teammates, offer support, and contribute to a positive team environment.

3. Respect Their Role:

- Understand their responsibilities:** Recognize that your team leader has the authority to make decisions and guide the team.
- Follow instructions:** While offering suggestions is welcome, ultimately respect their decisions and direction.
- Support their leadership:** Publicly support their initiatives and help create a positive team environment.

5- Transactional Leadership

Leaders who **guide** or **motivate** their followers in the direction of established goals by **clarifying role** and **task** requirements.

Description: Focuses on clear goals, structures, and rewards. Leaders establish expectations and provide feedback based on performance.



When To Use:

- **Routine and predictable tasks:** When tasks and activities are routine and predictable, a transactional leader can provide clear instructions, set expectations, and ensure that team members are meeting performance standards.
 - **High-stress environments:** In high-stress environments such as emergency services, transactional leadership can help maintain order, prioritize tasks, and ensure that team members are following established protocols and procedures.
 - **Short-term projects:** When the organization is working on short-term projects, transactional leadership can help ensure that tasks are completed on time and within budget.
 - **Newly formed teams:** When teams are newly formed, transactional leadership can help establish clear roles and responsibilities, set expectations, and provide direction.
 - **Performance-based work environments:** In performance-based work environments such as sales, transactional leadership can help motivate employees by providing incentives and rewards for achieving specific goals.
- **Advantages:** Efficient and results-oriented, clear expectations, good for short-term goals.
 - **Disadvantages:** Can stifle creativity and innovation, may lead to a focus on individual rewards over collective goals.

How to deal with Transactional Leader

- **Be reliable:**
 - Transactional leaders place a high value on reliability and consistency.
 - Understand expectations, meet deadlines, follow established procedures, and focus on achieving performance targets.
- **Be goal-oriented:**
 - Transactional leaders are focused on achieving specific goals and objectives. Make sure that your work is aligned with the organization's objectives and that you are making progress towards achieving them.
 - Seek clarification on performance metrics if needed.
- **Provide regular updates:**
 - Keep your transactional leader informed of your progress and provide regular updates on your work.
 - This helps to build trust and demonstrates your commitment to achieving the organization's goals.

6. Transformational Leadership

Inspires and motivates followers to achieve extraordinary outcomes and develop their own leadership capacity. Leaders act as role models, fostering a sense of shared purpose and encouraging innovation.

When To Use:

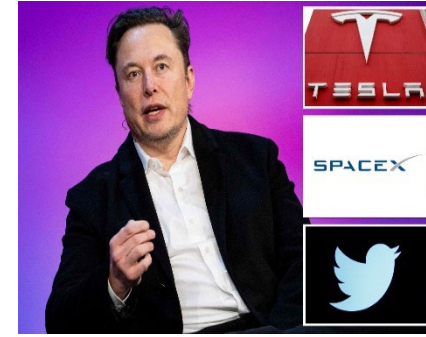
- When creativity, innovation, and change are required.
- When the leader is leading a team of highly skilled and motivated individuals who are willing to take risks and work towards a common goal.
- In industries such as technology, design, and creative fields, where innovation and creativity are highly valued.
- When the organization is undergoing significant changes, such as mergers or acquisitions, and needs a leader who can inspire and motivate employees during the transition period.

Advantage

- High employee engagement, increased motivation, strong team cohesion, promotes creativity.

Disadvantages:

- Can be ineffective in crisis situations requiring quick decisions, potential for burnout if leaders are not mindful of their own well-being.



How to deal with Transformational Leader

- **Embrace Change:**

- Transformational leaders often initiate change, so it is important to be adaptable and open to new ideas.
- Be willing to learn and try new things and embrace change as an opportunity for growth and development..

- **Be Proactive:**

- Transformational leaders value employees who take initiative and are proactive in their roles.
- Take ownership of your work, seek out opportunities to contribute to the team, and be willing to take on new challenges.

- **Actively contribute to the shared vision.:**

- Align personal goals with the leader's vision.

7- Charismatic Leaders

An enthusiastic, self-confident leader whose personality and actions influence people to behave in certain ways

When To Use:

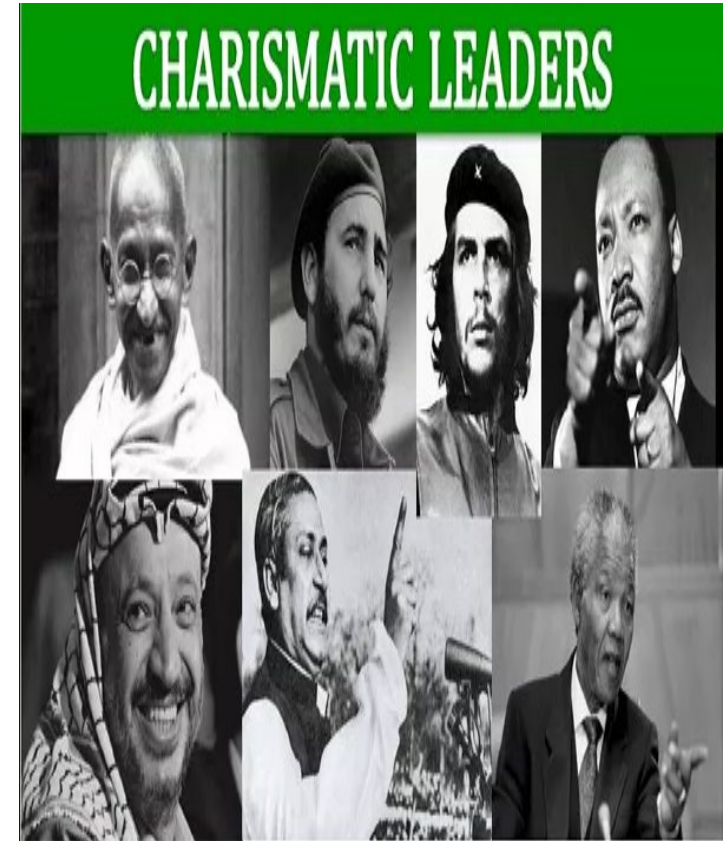
- This style is particularly effective during times of change, uncertainty
- When a strong sense of direction and motivation is needed.
- In organizations that require significant transformations or are facing challenging circumstances.

Advantage

- High employee engagement and motivation
- Strong team cohesion.
- Increased productivity and performance

Disadvantages:

- **Dependence on the leader:** The organization can become overly reliant on the leader, making succession planning difficult.
- **Potential for blind faith:** Followers might overlook flaws or make poor decisions due to their strong belief in the leader.
- **Difficulty with criticism:** Charismatic leaders might not be receptive to feedback or dissenting opinions.



How to deal with Charismatic Leader

▪ Understand their Vision:

- Charismatic leaders have a clear and compelling vision for the future.
- To be effective, it is important to understand their vision and how it relates to your role in the organization. Ask questions and seek clarification if necessary.

▪ Align your Goals:

- Charismatic leaders are often passionate about their work and their vision.
- To be effective, it is important to align your own goals with those of the leader and the organization. This will help you to stay motivated and engaged in your work.

Leadership Style	Description	When to Use	Advantages	Disadvantages
Autocratic	Leader makes all decisions without consulting others Highly centralized and directive.	- Crisis situations- Urgent decisions - Inexperienced or unmotivated teams - When leader has more expertise	- Quick decisions- Clear direction - Effective in crises	- Low morale & satisfaction - High turnover & Limited creativity- Lack of trust
Democratic	Leader involves team in decision-making but keeps final say Collaborative and communicative.	- Teams with expertise - Creative projects - Stable environments	- High moral - Encourages creativity - High satisfaction & productivity	- Slow decision-making - Ineffective in high pressure
Laissez-Faire	Leader delegates decisions, minimal supervision Team has freedom.	- Creative/research projects - Skilled professionals - Flexible environments	- High job satisfaction - Encourages innovation - Focus on strengths	- Lack of direction - Weak accountability
Team Leadership	Leader motivates, coordinates, and guides team to goals Balances tasks and relationships.	- New/inexperienced teams- - Complex tasks- For better communication with management	- Better team performance- Strong communication	- Time-consuming - May value relationships over results
Transactional	Based on structure, rewards, and clear roles; leader sets expectations and monitors.	- Routine tasks- High-stress settings - Short-term projects- New teams - Performance-based work	- Efficient- Clear goals - Good for short-term	- Limits creativity - Focus on rewards over team goals
Transformational	Inspires followers, drives innovation and change -Role model & shared vision.	- Innovation and creativity - Skilled/motivated teams - Organizational change	- High engagement - Creativity & cohesion - Strong motivation	- Weak in crises - Risk of burnout
Charismatic	Leader influences with personality, energy, and confidence -Inspires followers deeply.	- Times of change or uncertainty - Transformations- Need strong direction	- High motivation - Strong cohesion - Boosted performance	- Dependence on leader- Risk of blind faith - Poor reception of criticism



Leadership Style Evaluation Form



**which leadership style are
you?**

Leadership Styles

1. Autocratic Leadership

2. Democratic Leadership

3. Laissez-Faire

4- Team Leadership

5- Transactional Leadership

6-Transformational Leadership

7- Charismatic Leaders

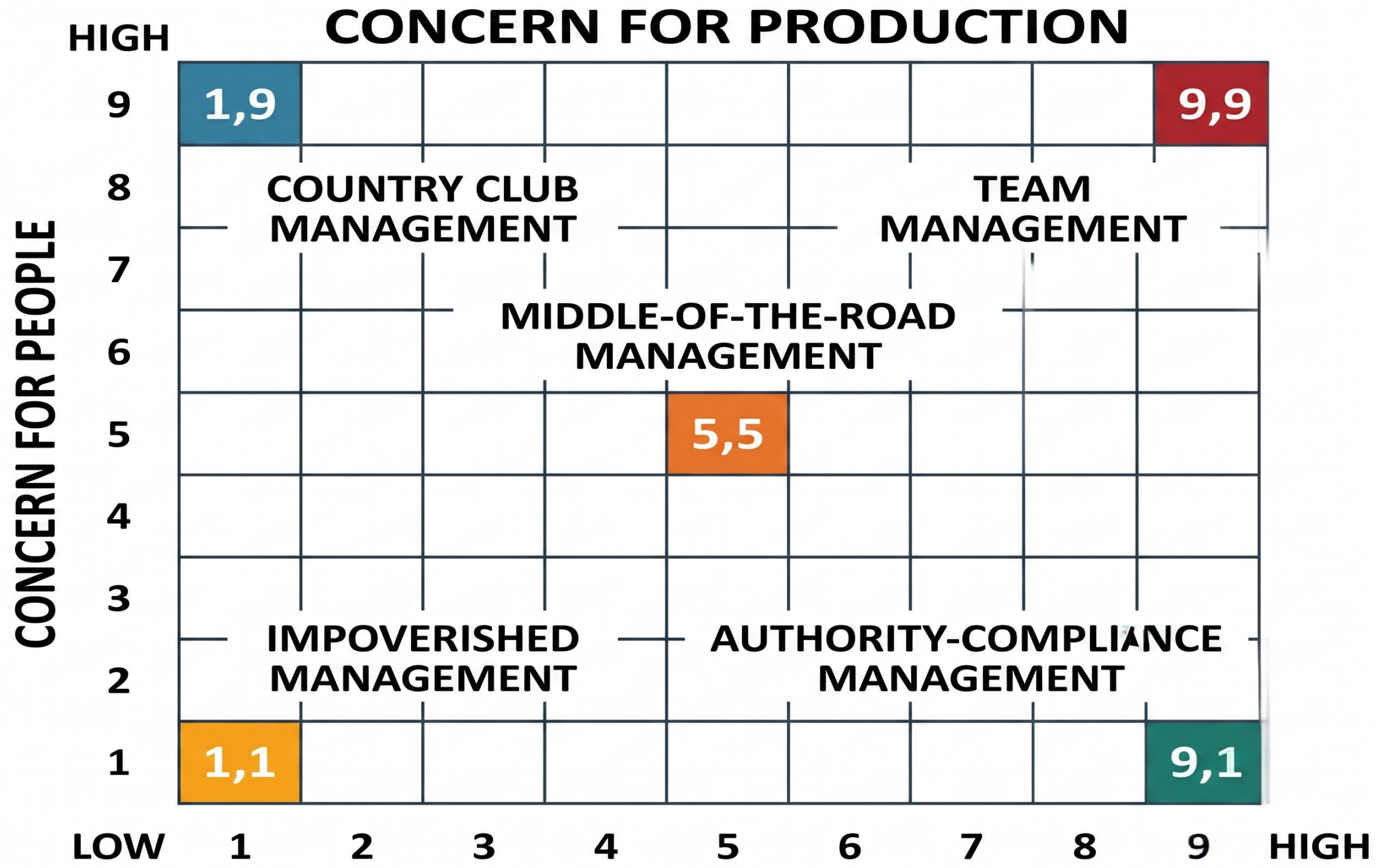


leadership Theories

The Managerial Grid

1. The Managerial Grid

- Is a leadership model developed by Robert Blake and Jane Mouton in 1964.
- It identifies five different leadership styles based on two key dimensions:
- **Concern for Production** (X-axis): Focus on tasks, results, efficiency, and organizational objectives
- **Concern for People** (Y-axis): Focus on employees' needs, relationships, morale, and personal development
- Each dimension is rated on a scale from 1 (low) to 9 (high), creating an 81-position grid with **five primary** leadership styles at key coordinates.



1. The Managerial Grid

Concern for Production (Horizontal Axis)

This represents the leader's emphasis on:

- Task accomplishment and results
- Meeting deadlines and targets
- Operational efficiency and productivity
- Quality standards and performance metrics
- Organizational goals and bottom-line results
- Systems, processes, and procedures

Low concern (1): Minimal attention to work output, deadlines, or results

High concern (9): Maximum focus on productivity, efficiency, and task completion

Concern for People (Vertical Axis)

This represents the leader's emphasis on:

- Employee well-being and satisfaction
- Team morale and motivation
- Interpersonal relationships
- Personal development and growth
- Work-life balance and working conditions
- Employee involvement and participation

Low concern (1): Minimal attention to people's needs or feelings

High concern (9): Maximum focus on employee welfare and relationships

Impoverished Management (1,1)

Position: Low Concern for People + Low Concern for Production

Characteristics:

- Minimum effort to get work done
- Minimal involvement in both task and people management
- Avoids responsibility and commitment
- Does just enough to avoid being fired
- Essentially "management by absence"

Leader Behavior:

- Delegates most work and avoids making decisions
- Shows little interest in team or results
- Passes problems to others
- Maintains detachment from both people and work

Impact on Organization:

- Low productivity and poor quality
- High employee dissatisfaction and turnover
- Lack of direction and coordination
- Organizational chaos and inefficiency



When This Occurs:

- Leader is burned out or demoralized
- Preparing to retire or leave
- Has given up after repeated failures
- Lacks skills or motivation for the role

Outcome:

This is the least effective leadership style and should be addressed immediately through coaching, reassignment, or termination.

2. Country Club Management (1,9)

Position: High Concern for People + Low Concern for Production

Characteristics:

- Primary focus on creating a comfortable, friendly work environment
- Believes happy employees will naturally be productive
- Avoids conflict and difficult conversations
- Prioritizes relationships over results

Leader Behavior:

- Creates relaxed, supportive atmosphere
- Rarely enforces standards or holds people accountable
- Focuses on team-building and morale
- Accommodates employees' preferences and requests
- Avoids confrontation even when performance is poor

Impact on Organization:

- High employee satisfaction initially
- Low productivity and missed targets
- Lack of accountability for results
- Standards and quality may slip

Common in:

- Organizations without strong competitive pressure
- Leaders who fear conflict
- Environments recovering from toxic leadership



Strengths	Weaknesses
•Low turnover in short term •Positive team atmosphere •Good employee relationships •Creative and collaborative environment	•Results suffer significantly •High performers may leave due to lack of standards •Organization may fail to meet market demands •Creates culture of complacency

3. Task Management (9,1)

Position: Low Concern for People + High Concern for Production

Characteristics:

- Results-oriented at all costs
- Views employees as tools to achieve objectives
- Autocratic and controlling
- Efficiency and productivity trump all else

Leader Behavior:

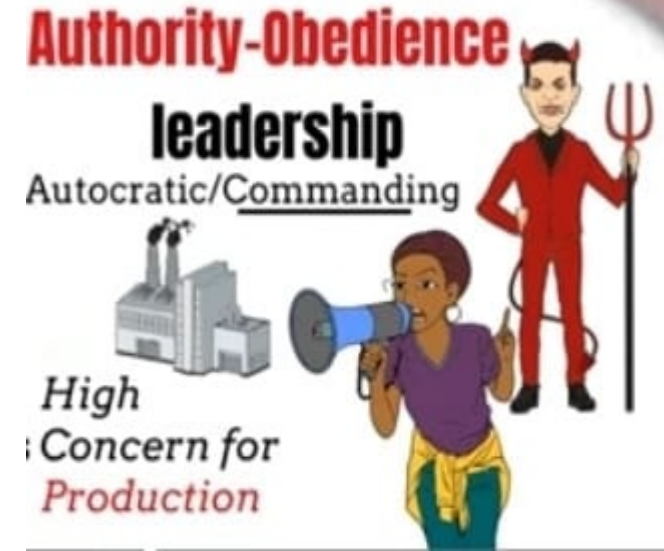
- Sets strict standards and demands compliance
- Makes all decisions unilaterally
- Closely monitors and controls work
- Focuses on systems, procedures, and metrics
- Shows little interest in employee welfare or development

Impact on Organization:

- High short-term productivity (often)
- Poor employee morale and engagement
- High stress and burnout
- Elevated turnover
- Creativity and innovation suppressed

Common in:

- Manufacturing and production environments
- Crisis or Org change situations



Strengths	Weaknesses
•Clear expectations and accountability •Efficient operations •Gets results in crisis situations •Works with inexperienced teams needing direction	•Unsustainable long-term •Damages employee relationships •Misses valuable input and ideas •Creates fear-based culture - Loses top talent

4. Middle-of-the-Road Management (5,5)

Position: Moderate Concern for People + Moderate Concern for Production

Characteristics:

- Seeks balance and compromise
- "Good enough" approach to both people and production
- Avoids extremes in either direction
- Political and diplomatic

Leader Behavior:

- Balances task demands with people needs
- Follows established precedents
- Seeks acceptable rather than optimal solutions
- Maintains status quo

Impact on Organization:

- Adequate but not exceptional performance
- Moderate employee satisfaction
- Stable but not innovative
- Incremental improvements only
- Risk-averse culture

Common in:

- Bureaucratic organizations
- Politically charged environments
- Risk-averse industries
- Leaders avoiding making tough choices



Strengths	Weaknesses
•Maintains organizational stability •Reduces extreme conflict •Acceptable performance levels Sustainable over time	•Mediocre results and engagement •Missed opportunities for excellence •Lacks inspiration or vision •Organization may fall behind competitors

5. Team Management (9,9)

Position: High Concern for People + High Concern for Production

Characteristics:

- Believes people and production are interdependent
- High performance comes through committed people
- Integrates task and relationship needs
- Creates environment of trust and respect

Leader Behavior:

- Sets challenging goals with team input
- Involves people in decision-making
- Develops capabilities and empowers team
- Holds high standards while supporting people
- Fosters collaboration and innovation
- Addresses conflicts constructively

Impact on Organization:

- High productivity and quality
- High employee engagement and satisfaction
- Innovation and continuous improvement
- Low turnover of top performers
- Strong organizational culture
- Sustainable competitive advantage

Common in:

High-performing organizations, Knowledge-based industries, Innovative companies & Organizations with strong cultures



Strengths	Challenges
•Best long-term organizational performance •Builds strong teams and leaders •Attracts and retains talent •Adapts well to change •Maximizes human potential	•Requires skilled, mature leadership •Takes time to build this culture •Demanding on the leader •May struggle in extreme crisis requiring quick autocratic decisions •Can be difficult in environments with very low-skilled workers

Usage of the grid

1-Diagnose Leadership Gaps:

- Identify leaders stuck in ineffective styles
- Understand organizational culture patterns
- Pinpoint development needs

2-Create Development Plans:

Strategy	From	To	Development Focus
Help leaders develop people skills	(9,1)	(9,9)	Emotional intelligence, coaching skills, participative decision-making
Encourage (1,9) leaders to raise performance standards	(1,9)	(9,9)	Performance management, accountability, results orientation
Move	(5,5)	(9,9)	Strategic thinking, courage, raising standards, inspiration
Address (1,1) through coaching or exit	(1,1)	Any	Motivation, engagement, basic management skills (or exit)

Usage of the grid

3. Situational Flexibility

While (9,9) is the ideal, effective leaders recognize when to flex:

Crisis Situations: May temporarily shift toward (9,1)

- Quick decisions needed
- Safety-critical situations
- Organizational survival threats

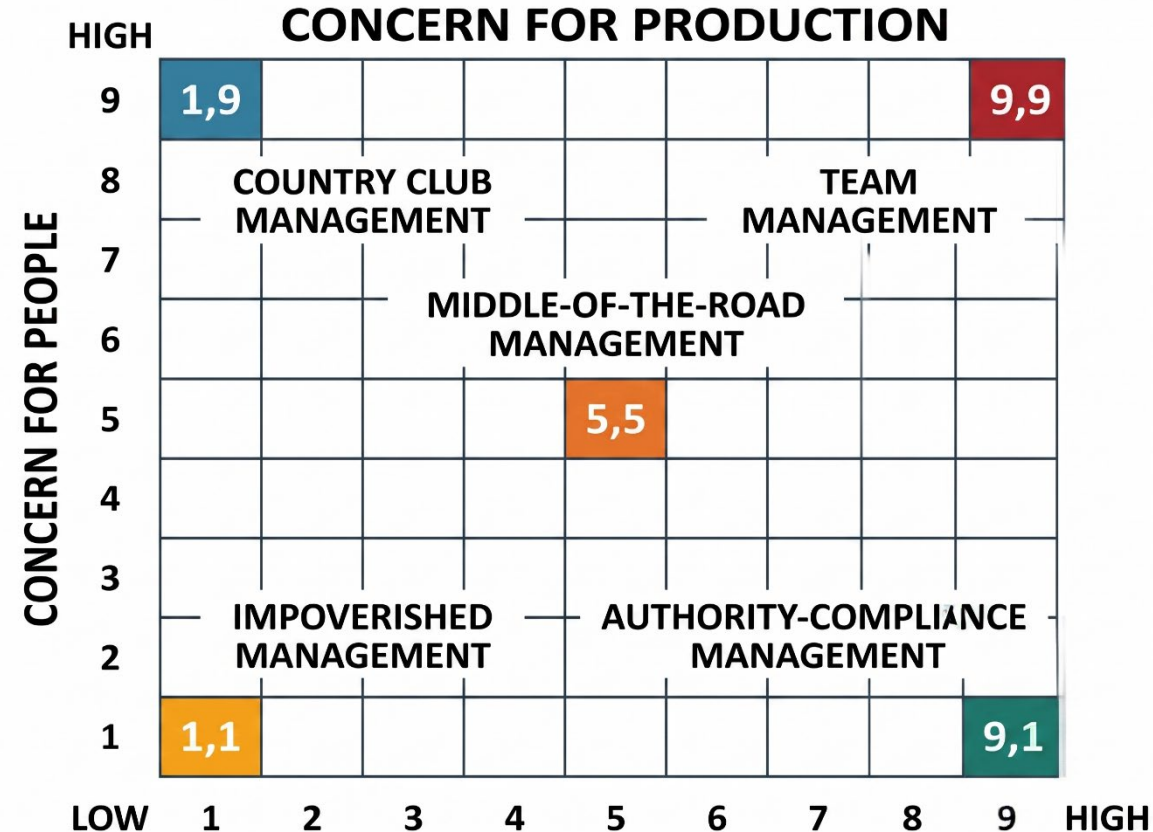
Creative Projects: May lean toward (1,9) temporarily

- Brainstorming phases
- Building team cohesion
- Recovery from high-pressure period

Routine Operations: Might use (5,5) approach

- Stable, predictable work
- Maintaining consistency
- Managing through established systems

The key: Return to (9,9) as the default and be conscious of style shifts.



Situational Leadership Theory

2- Situational Leadership Theory

The theory proposes that **leaders should adapt their leadership style to the followers' level of readiness**, which is the extent to which people have the **ability** and **willingness** to accomplish a specific task.

- The Aim of this model is to use emotional intelligence to reach resonant leadership style.
- **Resonant leadership style:** A leader who use the component of emotional intelligence to determine which style to use.
- All styles should be used at different occasions at different degrees.

Emotional Intelligence
Self-Awareness
Self-Management
Social Awareness
Relationship Management

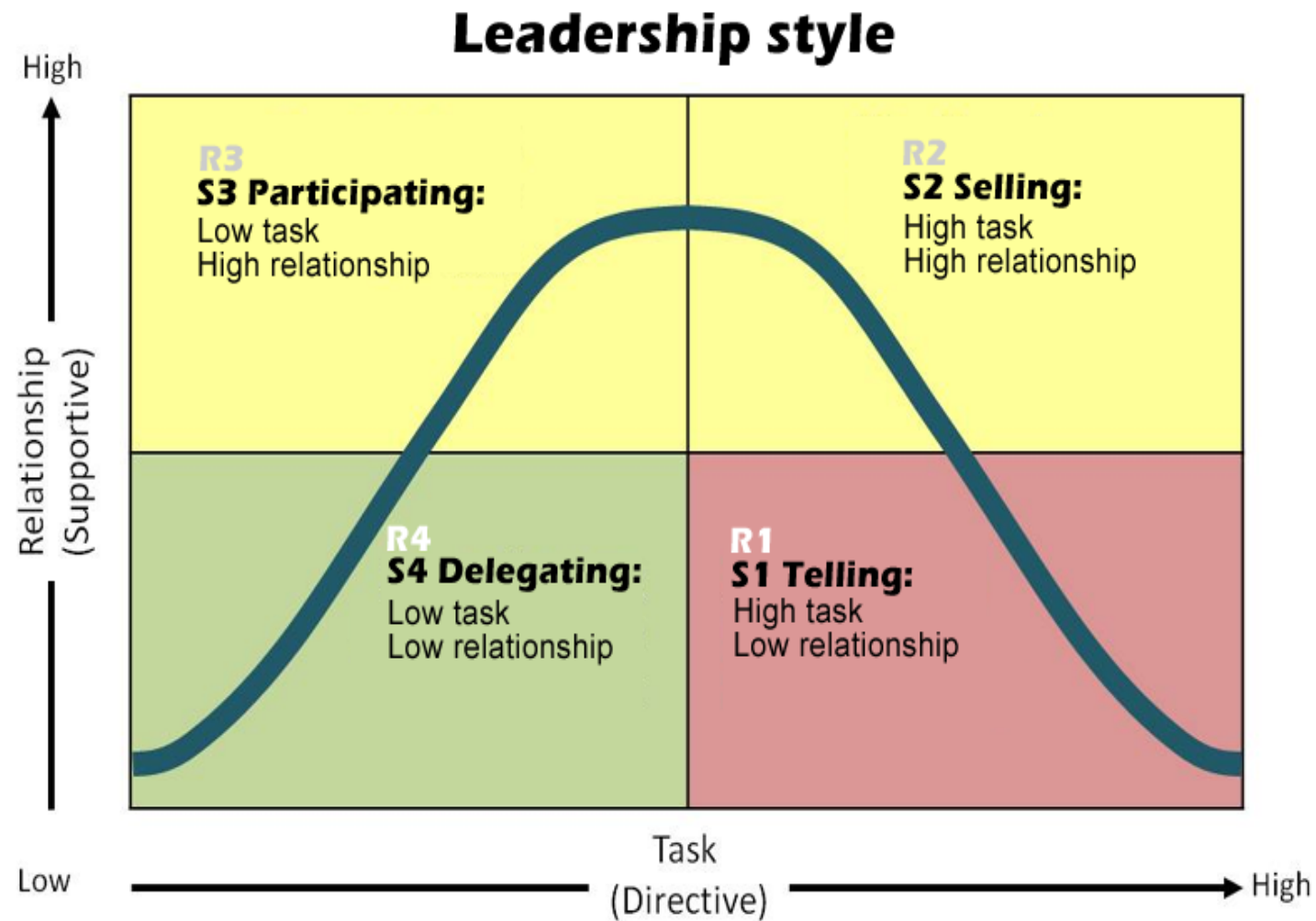
The Y-Axis:

- Signifies the degree of **Supportive Behavior** that the leader must exhibit.

The X-Axis:

- Signifies the degree of **Directive Behavior** that the leader must exhibit.

- This bar signifies the **Development of the employee**.
- Moving from right to left, the employee is becoming more competent and more confident at his/her job.

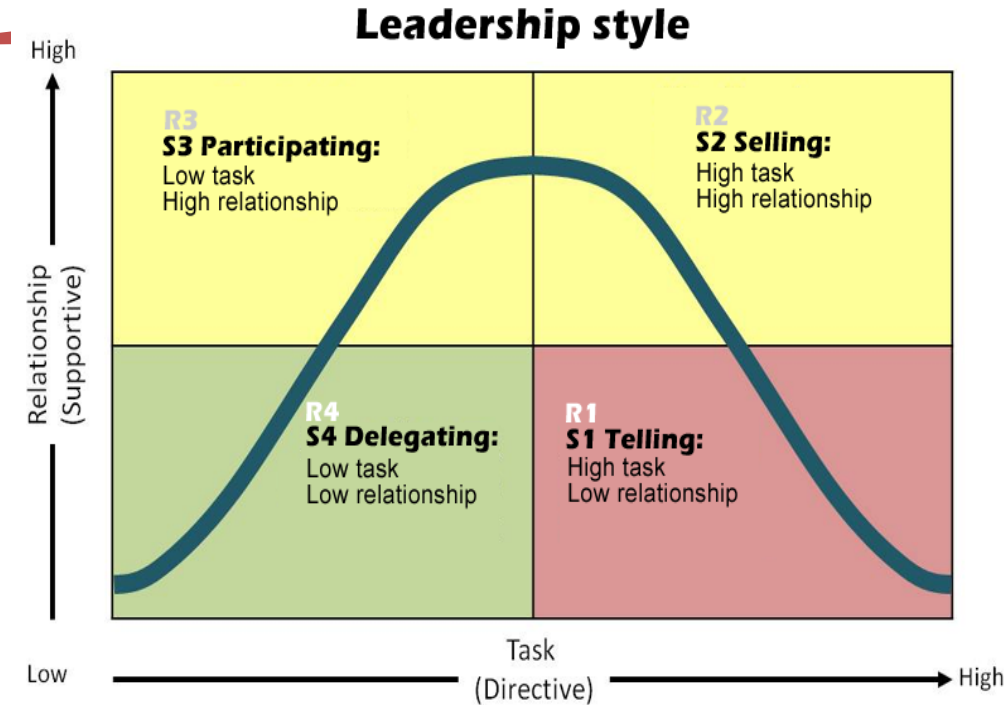


Developed ← **Developing**
Development Level of the Individual

2- Situational Leadership Theory

The theory identifies **four stages** of follower readiness:

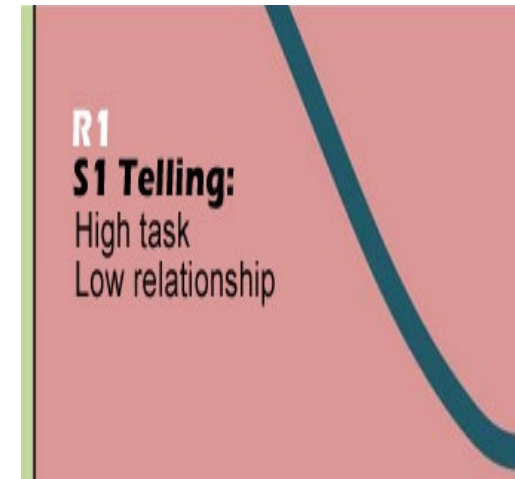
- **R1 (Unable + Unwilling):** They don't have the skill *and* they don't want to do it (maybe fearful, insecure, or resistant).
- **R2 (Unable + Willing):** They don't yet have the skills, but they *want* to try (motivated learners).
- **R3 (Able + Unwilling):** They have the skills, but they lack motivation or confidence (maybe bored, not committed, or skeptical).
- **R4 (Able + Willing):** They have both skill and motivation (independent performers).
- The theory suggests that leaders should adapt their leadership style to the followers' level of readiness.



- **Able** → This is about **competence**.
 - Do they have the skills, experience, and knowledge to do the task?
- **Willing** → This is about **commitment or motivation**.
 - Do they have the confidence, motivation, and desire to actually do it?

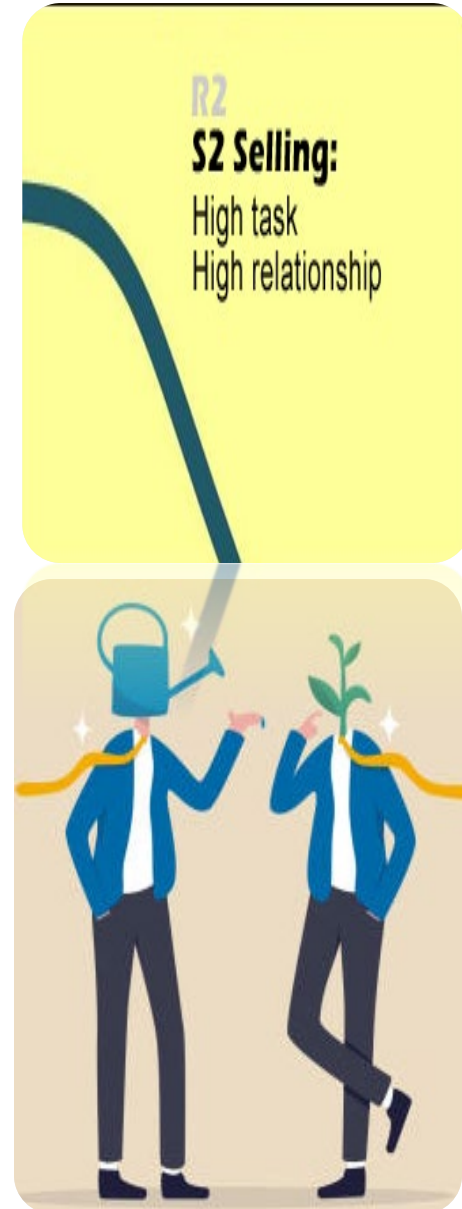
S1 Telling / Directing (High Task, Low Relationship)

- Employees: (R1) Followers who are **both unable** and **unwilling** to take responsibility.
- **Leader's Focus:** Provides specific instructions and closely supervises task completion.
- **Behavioral Emphasis:** Primarily on the **task** – detailing **who does what, when, and how**.
- **When to Use:**
 - With individuals or teams at a lower development level (new, untrained, or unsure about tasks).
 - When clarity, structure, and a high degree of supervision are necessary.
- **Typical Approach:**
 - Set clear, step-by-step expectations.
 - Monitor progress closely and correct errors immediately.



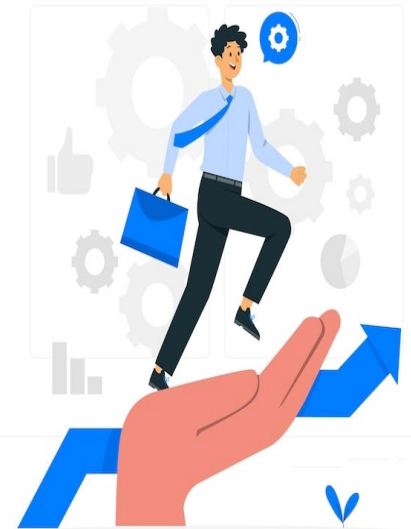
S2 – Selling / Coaching (High Task, High Relationship)

- Employees: (R2) People are **unable** but **willing** to do the necessary job tasks.
- **Leader's Focus:** Still provides direction, but with a greater emphasis on **explaining “why”** and **involving team members**.
- **Behavioral Emphasis:** **Balances the need for detailed guidance with supportive behaviors** encouragement, active listening, and opportunities for input.
- **When to Use:**
 - When individuals are still learning but have enough knowledge to benefit from more two-way dialogue.
 - When motivation dips after initial enthusiasm or when team members need both guidance and morale-boosting support.
- **Typical Approach:**
 - Offer suggestions, ask for feedback, and clarify reasoning behind decisions.
 - Combine instruction with encouragement and involvement in problem-solving.



S3 – Participating / Supporting (Low Task, High Relationship)

- Employees: (People are **able** but **unwilling** to do what the leader wants).
- **Leader's Focus:** Collaboration and high support, while team members assume more responsibility for how work is done.
- **Behavioral Emphasis:** **Low directive** (fewer step-by-step instructions), but **high supportive** leaders listen actively, facilitate, and build confidence.
- **When to Use:**
 - When individuals or teams have the skills/competence to perform tasks well but may lack confidence or need emotional/psychological support.
 - People are capable but still want a leader's support and recognition.
- **Typical Approach:**
 - Encourage team members to share ideas, make decisions, and take more ownership.
 - Provide praise, feedback, and resources rather than detailed instructions.



S4 – Delegating (Low Task, Low Relationship)

- Employees:(R4) who are both **able** and **willing** to perform tasks.
- **Leader's Focus:** Provides minimal direction and support team members have both high competence and confidence to work autonomously.
- **Behavioral Emphasis:** **Low on task** because individuals know what to do;
low on relationship because they don't require frequent support or feedback.
- **When to Use:**
 - With experienced, self-reliant individuals or teams (high skill, high commitment).
 - When members can set goals, solve problems, and handle responsibilities independently.
- **Typical Approach:**
 - Step back and allow team members freedom to decide on the “how,” while the leader remains available for consultation or final approvals.
 - Focus on results, not detailed supervision.





Thank
YOU!